

POSITION

2023 – 2026	Research Staff Research Group: Climate, Environmental and Resource Economics Project Coordination with IIASA on the EU-project <i>Land Management for Sustainability (LAMASUS)</i> : developing a governance model based on collaborative among policy makers, land users, and researchers	Austrian Institute of Economic Research (WIFO), Austria
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EDUCATION

2026 – 2027 <i>Admitted</i>	MSc in Medical Anthropology Focus: Environment. Supervisor: Prof. Eben Kirksey.	University of Oxford, United Kingdom
2024 – 2026	MA in Political Science with honors Final grade: 1.4 (Austrian scale: 1 = best possible grade, 5 = fail). Thesis: <i>The Birth of Eco-Biopolitics: Bringing More-than-human Life into Governance</i> . Supervisor: Sergej Seitz, PhD.	University of Vienna, Austria
2023 – 2026	MSc in Conservation Biology and Biodiversity Management with honors Final grade: 1.4 (Austrian scale). Thesis: <i>Dynamics of Reappearance of Nearly Extinct Anurans in a Tropical Region Highly Affected by Amphibian Declines</i> . Co-/Supervisor: Prof. Franz Essl; Carlos Adrián García-Rodríguez, PhD.	University of Vienna, Austria
2016 – 2023	BA in Political Science and BSc in Biology	University of Vienna, Austria

ACADEMIC SKILLS

Quantitative Methods	Regression (linear, logistic, panel, GLM); causal inference (Difference-in-Differences, quasi-experiments); time series analysis (forecasting); policy trend analysis
Qualitative Methods	Content analysis; interviews; discourse analysis; case studies
Machine Learning & Modeling	Random Forest (RF), Generalized Boosted Models (GBM), Generalized Additive Models (GAM); ensemble modeling (biomod2)
Ecological Modeling & Analysis	Species Distribution Modeling (SDM); multicollinearity analysis; COUE-framework, Niche Margin Index (NMI); model evaluation (AUC, TSS, Cohen's Kappa, Boyce)
Programming & Data Analysis	R: Data wrangling; statistical modeling; geospatial analysis; visualization
Geospatial Tools	QGIS

WORK IN PROGRESS

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles:

- Aref-Zahed, S. (forthcoming) 'The Wolf as Political Symbol: Populist Style and Exclusionary Governance in Austria', *Nature and Culture*.
- Aref-Zahed, S. (under review) 'Eco-Biopolitics and the Governance of More-Than-Human Life: Technocratic and Relational Configurations in the EU and Ecuador', *Environment and Planning E: Nature and Space*
- Aref-Zahed, S., Essl, F., Zumbado-Ulate, H., Acosta-Chaves, V.J., Chaves Cordero, G.A. & García-Rodríguez, C.A. (in preparation) 'Unexpected Returns: Reappearance Dynamics of Tropical Fogs After Regional Declines', *Diversity and Distribution*.

Editor-reviewed Book chapters:

- Aref-Zahed, S. (in press) 'Sacred Hydrology as Policy: Iranian Traditions of Water Governance', in Mandal, P.K. & Topoonyanont, W.S. (eds) *The Ecospiritual Narratives: Literature, Culture, and Media*. Palgrave Macmillan.
- Aref-Zahed, S. (under review) 'Eco-biopolitics: Resurrectable life and de-extinction', in Stark, H. (ed.) *Resurrecting Species: Speculative Engagements with De-Extinction*. Open Humanities Press.

Aref-Zahed, S. (under review; proposal accepted) ‘Eco-Biopolitics and the Governance of Plant Life in *The Overstory*’, in Gürova, E. (ed.) *The Plant Turn: Literature, Ecology, and the Green Imagination across Periods*. Publisher to be confirmed (under strong interest by Bloomsbury Academic’s Critical Plant Studies).

Aref-Zahed, S. (forthcoming) ‘hamnafas (هَمْنَفَس / co-breather)’, in Burke, B. & Fay-Stindt, Z. (eds) *A Lexicon for Animacy*. Publisher to be confirmed.

SELECTED CONFERENCE/WORKSHOP TALKS

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| 2026 | <i>Eco-Biopolitics and the Rights of Nature</i> . Animal Law Workshop. Presentation accepted and scheduled for September. | University of Cambridge, UK |
| 2026 | <i>Eco-Biopolitics: Making Life Count</i> . Environmental Justice Conference. Virtual presentation. | Colorado State University, USA |
| 2026 | <i>Governing Life Beyond the Human: Eco-Biopolitics and the Redistribution of Agency</i> . Philosophy of Agency in a More-Than-Human World Workshop. | University of Santiago de Compostela, Spain |
| 2026 | <i>Reconfiguration of geographic ranges and climatic niches during the recovery of declined anurans in Costa Rica</i> (with Héctor Zumbado-Ulate, Víctor Acosta-Chaves, Gerardo Chaves, Franz Essl, & Adrián García-Rodríguez). XIII Latin American Congress of Herpetology, presented by A. García-Rodríguez. | Costa Rica |
| 2025 | <i>Large Predators as Political Symbols: Right-Wing Populism and the Debate over Rewilding in Central and Western Europe</i> . Rethinking Wild Europe Conference. | University of Vienna, Austria |
| 2025 | <i>Modellierung von Wolfslebensräumen: Naturschutzpotenziale</i> (Modeling Wolf Habitats: Conservation Potential in Austria). Biodiversity Congress. | BOKU University, Austria |
| 2025 | <i>Assessing the Effectiveness of Price Observation Policies on Food Inflation in Europe: A Difference-in-Differences Approach</i> (with Franz Sinabell & Anna Renhart). 19 th International European Forum on System Dynamics and Innovation in Food Networks. | Germany |

INVITED GUEST LECTURES

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| 2025 | <i>Wolf Habitat Modeling in Austria</i> . UNESCO Chair: Sustainable Management of Conservation Areas (virtual). | Austria |
| 2025 | <i>Wolf politics in Austria</i> in the course “ <i>The Alps: Heights (and Depths) of Modernity</i> ” (taught by Associate Prof. Seth Peabody) (virtual). | Carleton College, USA |

SUMMER SCHOOLS

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| 2025 | Visegrad Environmental Philosophy Summer School on Water (VEPSS) | University of Wrocław, Poland |
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GRANTS

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| 2026 | Philosophy of Agency in a More-Than-Human World Workshop Grant, 250€ |
| 2025 | Erasmus+ Blended Intensive Program Grant for participation in the VEPSS, 838€. |

ORGANIZATION OF WORKSHOPS

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| 2026 | LAMASUS: 4 th Stakeholder-Board Workshop. | Belgium |
| 2026 | Austrian Case-Study Roadshow. | Austria |

LANGUAGES

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| Gilaki: native | English: C1 (IELTS Academic, band: 8) | Latin: reading knowledge |
| Farsi: native | Spanish: approx. A2 | |
| German: native | Mandarin: approx. A1 | |